

Gianna Brachetti-Truskawa

// Senior Product Manager | AI Products & Search | Startup to Scale | Multilingual

Product manager and organic growth leader with 17+ years in international search, spanning early-stage startups, scale-ups, and enterprise organisations. Native German speaker. Has managed web platforms with up to 900,000 daily active users. Published multi-level AI crawler governance with the IAB. Sees teams like an octopus: multiple independent, intelligent minds that align and grow as one organism. Cross-functional leadership across engineering, product, and marketing in 30+ language markets.

// EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, Search & CMS - DeepL SE

2022 - Present | Cologne

Enterprise AI translation platform. 200,000+ business customers, 100+ supported languages.

- > Joined as the company's first dedicated PM for organic and paid search. Leading a cross-functional team of 7 (engineers, QA, product designer, content strategist) and managing freelancers, owning new user growth and search experience strategy across organic and paid channels. Grew organic traffic by 200% within the first year.
- > Owning the search experience for anonymous web users - discovery, content surfacing, and conversion flows across 30+ language markets. Initially also product manager for Linguee, DeepL's linguistic search engine.
- > Owning the content pipeline for landing, comparison, and conversion pages. Establishing cross-functional SEO alignment across the entire company, bringing together engineering, product, and marketing to resolve structural growth blockers.
- > Working as product manager with a dedicated engineering team, shipping technical SEO, CRO, and Product Update Notifications. Owning and prioritising the tech SEO backlog. Practising agile, test-driven, and spec-driven development.
- > Building measurement and attribution dashboards (SQL, Metabase, Databricks) to track user acquisition across organic and paid channels. Migrated the reporting infrastructure from Clickhouse to Databricks, including building a migration tool to port dashboards and queries. Running A/B tests (Statsig) to validate growth hypotheses and inform conversion rate optimisation.
- > Built an internal search for the website based on Lunr as an experiment to improve content discovery.
- > Helping teams adopt and understand AI capabilities: built an automated prompt engineering framework (n8n, OpenRouter), custom Claude Code skills, and a Claude-to-Gemini skill porter. Shipped an open-source MCP server for Audisto API to integrate crawl data into AI-assisted SEO workflows.
- > Runs systematic competitive intelligence across the market: monitoring competitor HTML, site architecture, product changes, ad placement, and hiring signals to detect strategic direction early and reverse-engineer how search and AI systems respond. Built an internal LLM visibility tracker (hackathon, 2024) before commercial tools offered this capability.
- > Authored a multi-level AI crawler governance framework published by the IAB (2024), drawing on direct observation of AI crawler behaviour across DeepL's global web presence.
- > Introduced frontend e2e testing at the company, including specific SEO QA automation with SpeedCurve, Audisto, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, and Playwright for continuous quality monitoring.

VP of SEO - KaFe Rocks Ltd (acquired by Gaming Innovation Group)

2019 - 2022 | Malta / Remote

- > C-level SEO leadership at a high-growth iGaming startup, managing an affiliate portfolio of 70+ domains in a YMYL niche where advertising restrictions meant 99% of traffic and revenue depended on organic search.
- > Grew and stabilised the portfolio and launched a new domain with a community-driven content model.

// EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

- > Built and mentored the SEO and QA teams from scratch, establishing the technical excellence, domain management practices, and bot detection capabilities that made sustained growth possible. Introduced frontend end-to-end testing for SEO quality assurance.
- > Built systems and honeypots to detect and defend against fraudulent DMCA notices, content scraping, and copying - protecting the company's organic assets in a market where competitors actively attack each other's rankings.
- > Drove programmatic SEO strategy for scaled content generation across multiple regulated markets.

International Senior SEO Manager - bold ventures GmbH

2018 - 2019 | Cologne

- > Led technical and international SEO strategy for a software house, working exclusively with large enterprise clients in B2B eSignature technology and biopharmaceutical equipment manufacturing.
- > Optimised for multi-platform discovery including Spotify. Presented on multi-platform and micro search systems optimisation at conferences.

International Senior SEO / Audience Manager - Aufeminin Group

2017 | Cologne / Paris

- > Staff role reporting directly to the Managing Directors (Stabsstelle der GF). Led team of international SEO managers across the group's ad-funded European digital media properties, including user-generated content platforms (gofeminin.de, sofeminine.co.uk and locale variants) and editorially produced medical content (Onmeda.de and international equivalents).
- > Educated and guided large editorial teams on SEO best practices for both the UGC and medical content properties, driving content quality and search performance without formal line authority.
- > Designed and implemented server log monitoring and analysis process for crawl behaviour insights at scale.
- > Managed programmatic SEO for scaled content across multiple European markets.

Senior SEO Manager - Chefkoch GmbH

2015 - 2017 | Bonn

- > Managed SEO and search experience for Chefkoch.de, Germany's largest recipe search engine with a 65 million URL estate.
- > Fine-tuned and tested the on-site search (powered by Solr), including autocomplete, result ranking, and alternative suggestions for zero-result queries, using search result data, user behaviour signals, and A/B tests to improve relevance and discovery.
- > Applied data-driven analysis of search behaviour and conversion rate optimisation to feed insights back into content decisions and product features.
- > Established a systematic competitive intelligence practice: monitoring competitor sites at HTML level for changes in wording, site architecture, ad placements, and markup to detect product decisions early and reverse-engineer how search systems respond to those changes.
- > Selected by Google as the first company in Germany to test new structured data markup formats (Schema.org/JSON-LD) before they became official search features. Led the implementation and spearheaded adoption across Bertelsmann companies. Achieved over 100% visibility gain through Rich Results and AMP.
- > Designed and built a context-sensitive affiliate product placement feature that programmatically adapted to the user's search query and the recipe they were viewing, creating a new revenue stream for the company.
- > Drove programmatic SEO for scaled recipe and category page generation.
- > Built automated JIRA-based content optimisation workflow, reducing manual coordination overhead across editorial and development teams.

Head of SEO - netspirits GmbH & Co. KG

2014 - 2015 | Cologne

- > Built new SEO expert team from scratch. Developed content marketing strategies for clients across eCommerce, NGOs, and web hosting.

// EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Team Lead SEO - arvato Bertelsmann

2012 - 2014 | Cologne

- > Led team of four SEO specialists managing large international e-commerce projects for Microsoft, ASUS, Toshiba, and major online pharmacies in a regulated healthcare market.
- > Provided technical consulting for CMS migrations across Magento, Hybris, and Demandware platforms.

// SKILLS & EXPERTISE

SEARCH & DISCOVERY

Search relevance, Autocomplete, Query understanding, A/B testing, Conversion rate optimisation, Strategic International SEO, Technical SEO, On-page SEO, Keyword research, Query fan-out analysis, Core Web Vitals, Log file analysis, Schema / JSON-LD, Content architecture, Crawl infrastructure, Localisation, Multi-language content

AI & SECURITY

AI crawler governance, GEO (Generative Engine Optimisation), Prompt engineering, Meta-prompting, LLM behaviour analysis, Crawl security, Adversarial content analysis

PRODUCT & LEADERSHIP

Cross-functional programme leadership, Framework design, Stakeholder communication, Executive presentation, Systems thinking, Team building, coaching & mentoring, Freelancer management

TOOLS & DATA

Google Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools, Naver Search Advisor, Yandex Webmaster, GA4, Statsig, Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, Semrush, Audisto, Botify, Metabase, Solr, Elasticsearch, Lunr, n8n, OpenRouter, Claude CLI, Gemini CLI

HUMAN LANGUAGES

German (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Italian (intermediate), Turkish (intermediate), Spanish & Portuguese (written understanding), Dutch (beginner), Norwegian (beginner)

MACHINE LANGUAGES

SQL (basics), Python (basics)

// PUBLICATIONS

- > Multi-Level Approach to Managing AI Crawler Behaviour and Content Protection (IAB, 2024)
- > Qualification Characteristics of Swearwords and Their Significance in Translation (Bachelor thesis, 2012)

// MEMBERSHIPS

- > WiCyS - Women in Cybersecurity (since 2025)
- > Women4Cyber Foundation (since 2025)

// EDUCATION

BA Multilingual Communication (grade 1.3)

2012

TH Koeln - Cologne University of Applied Sciences

Commercial Agent in Dialogue Marketing (Apprenticeship)

2008

IHK

// CONTINUING EDUCATION

Building AI Copilots (certified)

2026

Maven

Agentic SDLC

2026

Multiverse School

Actionable AI for Marketers (certified)

2025

Maven

Mental Health First Aid (certified)

2021

Central Institute of Mental Health

// ELSEWHERE

Personal connection to healthcare: half my family works in the sector. I have proofread and corrected medical research papers, helped write SOPs for hospitals, and run smaller security tests in my free time.

Volunteer in geriatric psychiatry (2004-2005). Faculty board member, TH Koeln (2011-2012). Former freelance translator (DE/EN/FR/IT).